## THE WORLD BANK

The World Bank is also the outcome of the Bretton Woods Conference in 1944 like the International Monetary Fund. The World Bank is headquartered in Washington D.C.

The World Bank is a vital source of financial and technical assistance to developing countries around the world. Its mission is to "fight poverty with passion and professionalism for lasting results, and to help people help themselves and their environment by providing resources, sharing knowledge, building capacity and forging partnerships in the public and private sectors."

World Bank is not a usual bank we are used to. As it targets to alleviate poverty and augment development among poorer nations of the world, it functions through collaborative institutions which are two in number. These, in turn, embark on development projects for the targeted countries. These development institutions are owned by 188 member countries, collectively. The two development institutions are the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) and the International Development Association (IDA). IBRD target middle-income, but credit worthy poorer countries and IDA target poorest countries. These development institutions are supported by International Finance Corporation (IFC), Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) and the International Centre for the Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID).

### World Bank Group Branches

- International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)
- International Development Association (IDA)
- International Finance Corporation (IFC)
- Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA)
- International Centre for the Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID)

Together, these branches provide low-interest loans, interest-free